

'Cat Surge Bombs Miners In Twin Bill

By BILL COUSINS

Times Sports Writer

University of Texas at El Paso's baseball doubleheader with Arizona started out just fine Saturday. The Miners held a 3-1 lead after five innings of the first game, and with staff ace Bob Knox on the mound, everything looked rosey for at least one WAC Southern Division win.

But then the University of Arizona got going and U.T. El Paso just got in the way as the Wildcats took 13-7 and 10-0 wins at Dudley Field.

The double loss dropped coach Andy Cohen's Miners to the .500 level for the first time this year (17-17) and lowered the conference mark even further to 2-7 after the first half of the WAC schedule. It was the Miners' fifth and sixth straight losses.

"We just got beat," was Cohen's simple explanation afterward. "They had just too much pitching for our hitters, and too much hitting for our pitching."

Cohen was right on both counts. The Wildcats pounded out ten extra base hits in the Saturday twinbill to go along with Mark Schimpf's one-hitter in the nightcap.

Knox kept his perfect won lost record in the first game, being charged with only three of the 'Cat runs. His perfect earned run average went down the drain, however, as Arizona got two earned tallies in its big nine-run sixth.

The Miners had taken a 3-1 lead midway through the opener with single runs in the second and fourth on Arizona the third.

But Arizona went through Knox, Mike Miller, and Mike Kruta, in the sixth before Bob Downing could get fore Bob Downing could get the third out, the third.

Miller was charged with the winning run in relief of Knox, dropping his record to 3-1.

Ed Anderson allowed 13 hits and seven runs for Arizona, but struck it out for his fourth win of the year against a single loss.

Schimpf was the whole story in the night cap. The Wildcat righthander gave the Miners just one hit, a sixth inning single by Downing that ricocheted off third baseman Bob Szczinski. Skip Baker, Downing's pinch runner, was the front end of a double play moments later to eliminate the Miners' only threat.

In fact, the only other U.T. El Paso base runner was Mark Miller who drew a first inning walk.

Schimpf got the only support he needed when Martin Reid slammed a home run to right center to lead off the second. UA got three more in the same frame, one in the fifth, three in the sixth and a couple more in the seventh to wrap it up.

Little Mike Hilton started and gave up Reid's blast. The 5-3 lefthander is now 1-4.

Unfortunately for the Miners, things may get worse before they get better. Arizona State comes to town next week for a three game set to close out the Miners home schedule.

Houston Trades Miller To Atlanta

HOUSTON (AP) — The Houston Astros traded reserve outfielder Norm Miller to the Atlanta Braves for relief pitcher Cecil Upshaw, Astros General Manager Spec Richardson announced Saturday night.

Upshaw, a 6-foot-6 veteran, went into the 1973 season with a 30-25 major league record and a career earned run average of 2.95. Last season he was 3-5 with a 3.67 ERA.

Miller, a top reserve and pinchhitter for the Astros, has been slowed this season by a back ailment. He did not suit up for Houston's 4-0 victory over San Diego Saturday.